

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

Civil Law and Motion Tentative Rulings
Hon. Stephanie L. Jamieson
Courtroom 8

627 W. 21st Street, Merced

Monday, August 03, 2026
8:15 a.m.

The following tentative rulings shall become the ruling of the court unless a party gives notice of intention to appear as follows:

1. You must call (209) 725-4240 to notify the court of your intent to appear.
2. You must give notice to all other parties before 4:00 p.m. of your intent to appear.

Per California Rules of Court, rule 3.1308(a)(1), failure to do both items 1 and 2 will result in no oral argument. *Note:* Notifying CourtCall (the court's telephonic appearance provider) of your intent to appear does not satisfy the requirement of notifying the court.

Case No.	Title / Description
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22CV-00355	Pedro Ortega vs Del Valle Farm Labor Services, Inc.
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Motion to Compel Defendant to Provide Further Responses to Plaintiff's Special Interrogatories (Set One) & Request for Monetary Sanctions

Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to Special Interrogatories, Set One, Nos. 1, 3, 17, 42, 47, 55, and 58 is GRANTED.

Defendant's objections are overruled except as to any objection based on privilege.

The court finds, after weighing the privacy concerns versus the relevance and importance of the requested information that the information is discoverable subject to redaction or anonymizing of personal identifiable information such as names, addresses, phone numbers, and Social Security numbers.

The court declines to limit the responses to Plaintiff's worksite at Castle Farms. The allegations in the complaint allege company-wide policies and practices in violation of the labor code. This inherently extends beyond the Castle Farms worksite. Nor has Defendant shown the burden of providing the information is so substantial or excessive

relative to its probative value that the information should not be provided. As such, the information is discoverable as to Defendant as a whole.

Accordingly, the motion is granted and Defendant is to provide further responses to Nos. 1, 3, 17, 42, 47, 55, and 58.

Defendant is to provide further responses within thirty (30) days of this court's order.

Monetary sanctions are granted in the amount of \$1,000.

Defendant is to pay the monetary sanctions within thirty (30) days of this court's order.

Motion to Compel Defendant to Provide Further Responses to Plaintiff's Requests for Production (Set One) And Requests for Monetary Sanctions

Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to Requests for Production, Set One, Nos. 1-5, 17, 20, 27, 37, 38, 39, 41, 42, 43, 54, 55, 57, 58, 59, and 60 is GRANTED IN PART.

Defendant's objections are overruled as to Nos. 1-5, 17, 20, 27, 37, 38, 39, 41, 42, 43, 54, 55, 57, and 58 except as to any objection based on privilege. Defendant's objections as to Requests 59 and 60 being overbroad are sustained.

The court finds, after weighing the privacy concerns versus the relevance and importance of the requested documents that the documents are discoverable subject to redaction or anonymizing of personally identifiable information such as names, addresses, phone numbers, and Social Security numbers.

The court declines to limit the responses to Plaintiff's worksite at Castle Farms. The allegations in the complaint allege company-wide policies and practices in violation of the labor code. This inherently extends beyond the Castle Farms worksite. Nor has Defendant shown that the burden of producing the documents is so substantial or excessive relative to its probative value that the documents should not be produced. As such, the information is discoverable as to Defendant as a whole.

Accordingly, the motion is granted in part and Defendant is to provide further responses to Nos. 1-5, 17, 20, 27, 37, 38, 39, 41, 42, 43, 54, 55, 57, and 58.

The motion is denied as to responses to Nos. 59 and 60 as those requests are overbroad.

The parties are encouraged to meet and confer regarding Defendant producing the documents based upon an agreed-upon representative sample. Absent an agreement between the parties, Defendant is to provide further responses as ordered.

Defendant is to provide further responses within thirty (30) days of this court's order.

Monetary sanctions are granted in the amount of \$1,500.

Defendant is to pay the monetary sanctions within thirty (30) days of this court's order.
